Simple Profit Analysis — Submission Notes

Deliverables

- `Simple_Profit_Analysis.xlsx` : completed Excel workbook with the source data, formulas, summary table, charts, and interview questions.
- `Superstore_sales_dataset.csv` : supporting raw-data extract used by the workbook.

Key findings from the dataset

Category	Total Sales	Total Profit	Profit Margin
Furniture	$741,999.80	$18,451.27	2.5%
Office Supplies	$719,047.03	$122,490.80	17.0%
Technology	$836,154.03	$145,454.95	17.4%
Overall	**$2,297,200.86**	**$286,397.02**	**12.5%**

Interview-ready answers

- **Revenue vs profit:** Revenue is the total sales amount; profit is the amount remaining after costs and discounts. Sales alone do not show how efficiently a category performs.
- **Why can sales be high but profit low?** Heavy discounting, higher product costs, returns, shipping costs, and an unfavorable product mix can reduce profit even when sales are strong.
- **Main conclusion:** Technology has the highest total sales and total profit, while Furniture has relatively high sales but a much lower profit margin. Profit margin should be reviewed alongside revenue.

Source

The workbook uses the public Sample Superstore transaction dataset (9,994 rows), downloaded from a public GitHub mirror of the commonly used Tableau Superstore dataset. The workbook's summary cells use Excel formulas (`SUMIF` , `AVERAGEIF` , `COUNTIF` , `RANK` , and `IFERROR`) so the analysis remains refreshable when the raw data changes.